

Key player — Hardik Singh

₹70 lakh

UP Rudras

UP Rudras boasts a Netherlands-heavy core strengthened with Paris Olympics gold medallists, with the women's team coach Paul Van Ass overseeing the tactics. While Lars Balk and Floris Wortelboer were acquired through the auction, Dutch midfielder Seve Van Ass has withdrawn, replaced by Great Britain's James Albery.

The attack will be led by GB's Sam Ward, Belgium's Tanguy Cosyns and India's Lalit Upadhyay. The midfield is also strong with the likes of India's Hardik Singh and Akashdeep Singh, alongside New Zealand's Kane Russell.

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Key player — Gonzalo Peillat

₹68 lakh

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Hyderabad Toofans

Hyderabad outbid the Pipers and Lancers to secure Germany's Gonzalo Peillat for ₹68 lakh, making the drag flick expert the most expensive overseas player this edition.

Head coach Pasha Gademan, Germany's assistant coach during its 2023 World Cup triumph and silver medal finish at the Paris Olympics, believes Peillat's experience and skill will be key to holding the team together both on and off the pitch.

The team has made smart acquisitions, including Arthur De Sloover, Nilakanta Sharma, Sumit Walmiki, Nic Woods, Zachary Wallace, and Dominic Dixon.

